

SARA FARHAT

Product Manager · Health Data Interoperability & AI-Powered Clinical Applications
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PROFILE SUMMARY

Clinical dietitian turned healthtech product manager — with bedside experience as a clinical dietitian, both inpatient and outpatient, and later on the operational front lines as a Prior Authorization and Acute Care Transition Specialist. The broken discharge processes, the prior auth fights with payers, the readmission crises — I didn't read about these in a case study. I lived them. That foundation is the edge: I don't just understand healthcare workflows, I've worked inside them.

6+ years across product management, clinical practice, and health data analytics. I specialize in **health data interoperability (C-CDA, Direct Secure Messaging), intelligent document processing, and AI-powered clinical applications** — with a track record of building from zero in organizations that had none of these functions. I've secured board-level investment for 0-to-1 products, led end-to-end vendor evaluation through NDA, BAA, and contract negotiation, extended ML products for provider performance scoring, and built the product operations infrastructure — discovery, feature request prioritization, and release communications — that didn't exist before I arrived.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Product Manager — Apps & Interoperability | Concord Technologies, B2B SaaS (5B pages PHI/yr · 3 of 5 largest US payers) June 2023 – Current

Direct Secure Messaging (DSM) — Strategic Product Lead

- **Shipped DSM from zero to private beta, publicly launched at HIMSS 2026:** Led 8 engineers through alpha testing to deliver Direct Secure Messaging — a C-CDA-based secure transport protocol for clinical-grade document exchange — integrated into Concord Connect™. Concord was already building into the IDP space; DSM provided the missing protocol layer that made that positioning credible to healthcare customers.
- **Secured 6-figure board investment:** Won executive approval by presenting the full DSM business case — positioning it as table-stakes infrastructure for Concord's IDP market entry — directly to the CEO, President, and leadership team, with a direct competitive response to players like Consensus.
- **Recommended Kno2 as strategic HISP partner — adopted by leadership:** Selected from a field of 4 candidates (Kno2, DataMotion, Rosetta Health, Secure Exchange Solutions) after conducting full evaluation — obtaining sandboxes, executing NDAs and BAAs, running engineering spikes across all 4 environments, and negotiating and redlining contracts. Delivered Pugh matrix recommendation and built a vendor-agnostic architecture to future-proof against lock-in.
- **Enabled clinical-grade data exchange for Concord Connect™:** Expanded the platform beyond cloud fax by architecting DSM to unify multiple inbound document streams (C-CDA, PDF, JPEG) into a single point-of-intake inbox — enabling straight-through processing into EHRs and positioning Concord Connect™ as a protocol-aware, multi-channel IDP solution. Defined AI-assisted data extraction logic for both structured and unstructured attachments and built lo-fi wireframes for the unified inbox integration.
- **Drove company-wide commercial readiness:** As Concord's sole healthcare domain expert, delivered a 6-session Lunch & Learn series to 80+ stakeholders (CEO, CTO, CMO, sales, implementation, support), produced a living SharePoint Q&A knowledge base, and co-authored the DSM user manual — activating a previously stalled sales team into proactive outreach targeting 15–20% conversion of existing Cloud Fax accounts to Concord Connect™.
- **Shifted GTM from blind outreach to segment-targeted strategy:** Built Concord's first healthcare market segmentation framework — mapping 7+ care settings (SNFs, LTACs, FQHCs, RCMs, specialty clinics, surgical centers, behavioral health) to user personas, JTBD frameworks, and user journeys. Replaced random customer outreach with intentional, segment-specific targeting for accounts including Seattle Children's, Inova, and R1 RCM.

Product Operations & Platform

- **Cleared 100+ untriaged feature requests for the first time:** Designed and deployed a feature request prioritization system in ADO using a custom RICE framework augmented with customer revenue tier and strategic alignment scoring — establishing Concord's first repeatable pipeline from intake to development across health systems, FQHCs, and RCM organizations.
- **Reduced user errors by fixing high-friction workflows:** Over a full year, established usability testing as a core product practice — recruiting end users across FQHCs, specialty clinics, and RCM orgs for structured sessions with the Senior UX/UI Designer. Findings directly drove error-reducing fixes to grid view, auto-merge, advanced search and document workflows inside Concord Connect™, used by 1,000+ users across 40+ healthcare sites.
- **Expanded product stakeholder reach from IT to clinical decision-makers:** Launched Concord's first structured product release communication program, automating user-benefit extraction from ADO epics into internal and external release templates. Result: the company began hearing directly from clinical managers, nursing managers, QI directors, innovation directors, and business development leaders — roles previously unreachable through IT-only channels.

Data & Product Analyst | *CareJourney — Healthcare Analytics* (2M+ providers · 300M beneficiaries · 10+ yrs longitudinal Medicare & Medicaid claims) Jan 2022 – March 2023

- **20% referral network growth + 17% cost index improvement:** Led cross-functional collaboration with UI/UX, Engineering, and Data Science to extend CareJourney's provider performance scoring product with new subspecialty coverage including general surgery — translating ML model outputs for risk adjustment and episode-of-care analysis into product features that gave health system customers actionable intelligence for referral optimization, cost benchmarking, and VBC strategy across 250+ clinical episodes.
- **Identified \$2,000+ in referral cost reduction opportunities per patient:** Conducted market landscape analysis to surface stronger referral network options, giving CareJourney customers a data-backed basis for optimizing provider selection across cost and quality dimensions — using longitudinal Medicare and Medicaid claims data covering 300M beneficiaries.
- **Built claims-based measure infrastructure supporting VBC reporting:** Translated CMS measure specifications into product-ready numerator and denominator logic using CCLF-based Medicare claims data — producing measure infrastructure that supported provider performance scoring for health systems in MSSP and ACO REACH arrangements. Constructed patient-to-provider attribution tables in SQL using commercial claims data from Change Healthcare, surfacing attribution logic into aggregated schemas consumed across scoring and reporting products.
- **15% faster time-to-market + 60% fewer support tickets:** Removed sprint blockers via Agile Burnup Chart tracking and introduced standardized QA processes that consistently surfaced bugs before production.

Acute Care Transition & Prior Authorization Specialist | *Kern Medical — Safety Net Hospital* Jan 2020 – Sep 2020

- **Readmission rate: 90th → 75th percentile** (CMS optimal target: ≤80th) — redesigned nursing discharge process by introducing disease management education, medication reconciliation, and a cross-functional ACT team post-discharge protocol across nursing, discharge, and pharmacy.
- **65% increase in prior authorization approvals** with non-contracted payers + **75% improvement in denial reversal rates** — directly improving patient access to care and hospital financial performance.
- **20% improvement in successful patient transitions:** Leveraged clinical data to identify correlations between readmission risk and gaps in patient education, medication adherence, and follow-up appointment compliance.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Healthcare Administration — California State University, Bakersfield

Bachelor of Science, Clinical Nutrition — American University of Beirut

Post-Graduate Certificate, Data Analytics — Purdue University

Advanced Product Management Training — Product Faculty

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO)

CORE SKILLS

Healthcare & Interoperability: C-CDA · Direct Secure Messaging (DSM) · HL7 · FHIR · HIPAA · EHR Integration · Intelligent Document Processing (IDP) · Health Information Exchange (HIE) · Prior Authorization · Revenue Cycle Management (RCM) · Risk Adjustment · Provider Performance Scoring · Care Transitions

Product Management: 0-to-1 Product Development · Product Strategy & Roadmap · Market & Competitive Analysis · Feature Request Prioritization · RICE Framework · Agile/Scrum · Backlog Management · User Story Writing · PRD · OKRs · KPI Definition · North Star Metrics · Voice of Customer (VoC)

UX & Research: User Research · Usability Testing · A/B Testing · User Journey Mapping · Lo-Fi Wireframing · Discovery & Stakeholder Interviews · Persona Development · Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD)

Stakeholder & Operations: Executive & Board Communication · Cross-Functional Leadership · Vendor Evaluation · Contract Negotiation (NDA · BAA · Redlines) · Sales Enablement · Change Management · Release Communications

Technical & Data: SQL · Python · Azure Application Insights · Azure DevOps (ADO) · AWS · Snowflake · Confluence · SharePoint · Feature Adoption Tracking · Retention & Engagement Analytics